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RAJALAKSHMI
INSTITUTE OF
TECHNOLOGY

GE261004 DESIGN THINKING

Unit V – Innovation, Entrepreneurship and Sustainability · Presentation 5 of 6

Pitch Preparation and Storytelling

Why a pitch is a story · three minutes, five moves · opening with a person · the ask · what belongs on a slide · delivery and questions

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In this presentation

- Why a pitch is a story
- Three minutes, five moves
- Opening with a person
- Making the ask
- The eight-slide deck
- What goes on a slide
- Delivery: do and do not
- Handling questions



1

The story

People remember a person in trouble; they forget a list of features

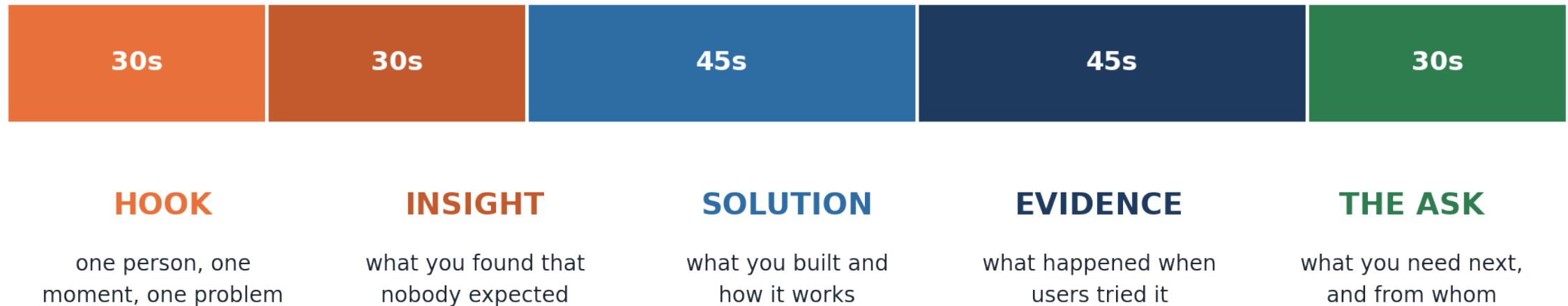
Why a pitch is a story

- A story gives the audience a reason to care before you give them information
- It is how you make a stranger hold the problem for three minutes
- The structure is not decoration – it is what makes the argument follow
- You are not summarising your project; you are making one specific case

KEY POINT Nobody funds a summary. They fund a problem they can now see, and a team they believe can solve it.

Three minutes, five moves

Three minutes, five moves



open with a person, close with a request — never with “thank you, any questions?”

Hook, insight, solution, evidence, ask – with the clock against you.

Opening with a person

- Name one real person from your field work and one moment that went wrong
- Fifteen seconds of a specific person beats a minute of statistics
- Then, and only then, say how many people are in the same position
- Never open with “we are team seven and our project is...”

KEY POINT The first fifteen seconds decide whether the rest is listened to or merely heard.

Making the ask

- End with what you want next, precisely – not with “thank you”
- Ask for something specific: an introduction, a test site, a mentor, a sum of money
- Say what you will do with it, and by when
- A pitch with no ask is a report, and reports do not get answered

KEY POINT The last sentence is the one people act on. Spend as long writing it as you spend on the opening.

2

The deck and the delivery

Eight slides, and what you do while they are up

The eight-slide deck

1

The problem,
as one person

2

The insight
you earned

3

Your solution,
shown not told

4

How it works,
briefly

5

What users did
with it

6

Who it is for,
and how many

7

What it costs,
who pays

8

What you need
next

One idea per slide, in this order – and no slide about your team's internal process.

What goes on a slide

- One idea per slide, and a title that states that idea as a sentence
- A photograph of the prototype in somebody's hands beats any diagram of it
- Numbers only where you measured them; say who and how many
- Nothing on a slide that you are going to read out loud

KEY POINT The slide is the evidence. You are the argument. If the slide can be read instead of heard, one of you is redundant.

Delivery

Do

- Rehearse aloud, against a clock
- Hold up the actual prototype
- Look at one person at a time
- Stop when you reach the ask

Do not

- Read the slide
- Apologise for what is missing
- Run over and get cut off
- Hide the thing that failed

KEY POINT Rehearse standing up, out loud, with the prototype in your hand. Reading it silently is not rehearsal.

Handling questions

- Answer the question asked, in one sentence, before adding anything
- “We do not know yet, and here is how we would find out” is a strong answer
- Never argue with the questioner; write it down and say you will check
- The hardest question is usually the most useful thing you will hear that day

KEY POINT Confidence is not claiming to know. It is knowing exactly which things you do not.

In class: pitch rehearsal

- Each team pitches for three minutes, strictly timed, with the prototype in hand
- Two other teams hold up a card when a slide is being read aloud
- The audience asks exactly two questions: one about evidence, one about cost
- Rewrite your first and last sentences before the final session

ACTIVITY Whole hour. Every team pitches once. The timer is enforced without exception.

THINK ABOUT IT

What is the one thing about your project you are hoping nobody asks?

- Why are you hoping that?
- Is it a gap in evidence or a flaw in the idea?
- What would it take to answer it honestly?
- What happens if you raise it yourself, first?

Summary

- A pitch is a story that earns attention before it gives information
- Five moves: hook, insight, solution, evidence, ask
- Open with one real person and one moment that went wrong
- End with a specific ask, not with thanks
- One idea per slide; the slide is evidence, you are the argument
- “We do not know yet, and here is how we would find out” is a strong answer

Next: Ethical considerations in design

- Every design is a decision about somebody
- The engineer's code of ethics
- Bias, privacy and persuasion
- Dark patterns, and three questions before you ship